

SENATE No. 1751

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Patrick M. O'Connor

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying resolve:

Resolve establishing a commission to study the Commonwealth's response to and resources for victims of domestic violence and sexual assault.

PETITION OF:

NAME:

Patrick M. O'Connor

DISTRICT/ADDRESS:

First Plymouth and Norfolk

SENATE No. 1751

By Mr. O'Connor, a petition (accompanied by resolve, Senate, No. 1751) of Patrick M. O'Connor that provisions be made for an investigation and study by a special commission to study the Commonwealth's response to and resources for victims of domestic violence and sexual assault. Public Safety and Homeland Security.

[SIMILAR MATTER FILED IN PREVIOUS SESSION
SEE SENATE, NO. 1576 OF 2023-2024.]

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

Resolve establishing a commission to study the Commonwealth's response to and resources for victims of domestic violence and sexual assault.

1 **Resolved**, Notwithstanding any general or special law to the contrary, there shall be
2 established a special commission to study the Commonwealth's response to and resources for
3 victims of domestic violence and sexual assault.

4 (a) The commission shall be comprised of the following members: the commissioner of
5 probation; the director of the juvenile court probation department; the director of the probate and
6 family court probation department; the director of the office of community corrections; the
7 director of the electronic monitoring center; the executive director of the governor's council to
8 address sexual assault and domestic violence; an assistant attorney general to be appointed by the
9 attorney general; the secretary of the executive office of public safety and security; the director
10 of the Massachusetts office for victim assistance; two SAFEPLAN advocates to be appointed by

the director of the Massachusetts office for victim assistance; the director of Jane Doe Inc. of Boston; the director of New Hope, Inc. of Attleboro; the director of the South Shore Resource and Advocacy Center; the director of the Massachusetts intimate partner abuse education program; a law enforcement officer with experience in domestic violence and sexual assault cases to be appointed by the governor; the head of the domestic violence unit within the Boston police department; and two survivors of domestic abuse to be appointed by the governor. The board shall be chaired by the director of the Massachusetts office for victim assistance. Each such member may appoint a designee to serve in the member's place.

(b) The commission shall analyze current resource offerings to victims of domestic violence and sexual assault; study the efficiency of state departments in maintaining victim safety, including but not limited to probation departments; consider ways to provide robust opportunities for victim and community engagement, ongoing analysis, and oversight of probation department policies, practices, and procedures; analyze income-based privileges and disadvantages for victims in participating with probation proceedings; consider ways to ensure that victims are part of the probation process while holding offenders accountable and simultaneously reducing the rates of recidivism; analyze probation violation reporting advisories and other written resources and whether they are helpful, understandable, and effective for victims; and determine the feasibility of a complaint communication tool for victims to report probation officer misconduct.

(c) The first meeting of the commission shall take place no later than December 1, 2025 and shall be organized by the director of the Massachusetts office for victim assistance.

32 (d) The commission shall produce a report of their findings and analysis along with any
33 recommendations for legislation to the Clerks of the House and Senate and the chairs of the Joint
34 Committee on the Judiciary no later than December 1, 2026.